



Petition to use transfer course for Global Core requirement

[The Global Core requirement](#) asks students to engage directly with the variety of civilizations and diversity of traditions that, along with the West, have formed the world and continue to interact in it today. Courses in the Global Core typically explore the cultures of Africa, Asia, the Americas, and the Middle East in an historical context, and are organized around a set of primary materials produced in these traditions, drawing from texts or other forms of media, as well as from oral sources or performance. Global Core courses fall into two categories: those that focus on a specific culture or civilization, tracing its existence across a significant span of time; and those that address a common theme or set of analytic questions comparatively (and may include Europe and the West).

Guidelines governing this Petition

Petitions are only accepted for courses taken at accredited universities or colleges prior to starting the GS BA degree that have been granted general transfer credit to the Columbia degree. Students should have received an Entrance Credit Report (ECR) from GS Admissions prior to submitting the petition below and should have confirmed with their Academic Advisor that the specific course was transferred to Columbia and valued at 3 or more Columbia credits.

- Petitions are reviewed by the GS Committee on Academic Standing at intervals during the academic year. The petition deadlines are **February 1st, March 15th, July 1st, August 15th, November 1st, December 15th**. Notification will be provided within 10 business days of the petition deadline. Petitions received after the above dates will be reviewed during the next interval.
- Students are strongly encouraged to petition for a course within one year of starting the GS degree to facilitate long-term academic planning.
- There is no appeal process; decisions made by this Committee are final.
- Petitions should be submitted to the student's GS Advising Dean.

What should my petition include?

- Petitions must include a written statement that explains why and how the course fulfills the aims of the [Global Core](#), the course syllabus, and any supporting materials that speak to the use of primary sources in the course. Please ensure that the syllabus includes the assigned work and readings. The statement should confirm that the course:
 - focuses exclusively on the non-western world OR takes a comparative approach with significant focus on the cultures of Africa, Asia, the Americas, and/or the Middle East
 - has a heavy emphasis on primary, rather than secondary, source materials.

Petition Information

Date: 11/14/2025

Student name: Sammy Abdella

Student Uni: sn3136

Advisor: Lauren Manzino

Course Information

(Course syllabus must be attached to this petition)

Attached below.

Course number and name: POLS 350 Religion and Politics in Comparative Perspective - 4 Credits

College or University where course was taken: Lehigh University

Semester and year course was taken: 2024 Summer Session

Statement on why course should count for Global Core:

Attached below.